

Feedback - Research Proposal Presentation
By Diego Navarra on Monday, 19 January 2026, 5:38 PM

Knowledge and Understanding of the Topic / Issues under Consideration (25%)

The presentation demonstrates clear knowledge of cybersecurity risks arising from IoT integration in power and utilities infrastructure. The research problem is defined within the context of increasing digitalisation of critical infrastructure and the associated exposure to cyber threats. Key concepts such as IoT vulnerabilities, threat vectors, attack surfaces, and operational impacts on power and utility systems are introduced and supported by relevant sector literature and policy drivers. The research aim and questions align with the stated problem and indicate awareness of both technical and industry relevance.

An area for improvement is the development of clearer conceptual definitions of central terms such as “IoT-based threats” and “critical infrastructure resilience”. Introducing a recognised cybersecurity framework (e.g., NIST or IEC 62443) as a conceptual anchor would provide greater precision and clarify how threats and mitigation strategies will be examined.

Criticality (25%)

There is evidence of literature synthesis, particularly in identifying gaps between existing technical security studies and sector-specific implementation challenges in power and utilities. The presentation justifies the proposed methodological approach by linking identified research gaps to the need for empirical investigation. Consideration is given to governance, regulatory constraints, and technical limitations, supporting the rationale for the study design.

To develop criticality further, clearer comparison of differing viewpoints in the literature is recommended. Currently, sources are mainly presented descriptively. Greater evaluation of contrasting findings on IoT security solutions, risk assessment methods, or resilience strategies would improve argument development and strengthen justification of the selected research approach.

Presentation and Communication Skills (30%)

The presentation follows a logical progression from context and problem definition to research questions, methodology, and expected contributions. Content is communicated clearly with appropriate academic tone and terminology. Visual elements support explanation of system architecture, threat pathways, and research workflow, aiding audience understanding.

Some slides contain dense text or multiple ideas per slide, which may reduce clarity during delivery. Reducing text volume and using summarised bullet points or diagrams would improve communication effectiveness. Introducing a brief visual overview of the research design earlier in the presentation would further support audience orientation.

Structure and Presentation (as detailed in the assessment guidance) (10%)

The presentation adheres to the expected structure for a research proposal, including background, problem statement, research questions, literature foundation, methodology, ethical considerations, artefact description, timeline, and conclusion. Sequencing of content is consistent with assessment guidance and supports logical flow.

Minor improvements could be achieved by adding a concise concluding slide restating the research contribution and next steps. Ensuring consistent formatting and alignment across slides would enhance structural coherence.

Use of Relevant Sources (10%)

The presentation demonstrates engagement with current academic and industry sources relating to IoT security, critical infrastructure protection, and cybersecurity governance. References are relevant to the research focus and support the identification of gaps and proposed contributions.

Further improvement could be made by briefly indicating how selected sources informed key design choices in the methodology. Including additional foundational cybersecurity standards or frameworks would broaden the theoretical grounding.